

JUSTIN RICHARD LEUNG

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Education

- 2021– **Doctor of Philosophy, Linguistics, University of Toronto**
Dissertation: *A multidimensional approach to heritage languages: Cantonese classifier constructions in Toronto*
Supervisor: Dr. Naomi Nagy
Committee Members: Dr. M. Cristina Cuervo, Dr. Emily Atkinson
- 2020–21 **Master of Arts, Linguistics, University of Toronto**
Forum Paper: *Directional motion event expression in Toronto Heritage Cantonese*
Supervisor: Dr. Naomi Nagy
Second reader: Dr. M. Cristina Cuervo
- 2019–20 **Non-degree Undergraduate Studies, University of Toronto Mississauga**
- 2015–19 **Honours Bachelor of Science (High Distinction), University of Toronto Mississauga**
Specialist in Bioinformatics, Minor in Linguistic Studies

Publications

Refereed

- 2025 **Leung, Justin R.** Detecting paths of change in the heritage context: Directional motion event expression in Cantonese spoken in Toronto and Hong Kong. *Asia-Pacific Language Variation* 11(1/2): 142–186.
- 2025 Kiss, Angelika, Roger Yu-Hsiang Lo & **Justin R. Leung**. What do Cantonese sentence-final particles tell us about rhetorical questions? In Tue Trinh, Anton Benz, Daniel Goodhue, Kazuko Yatsushiro & Manfred Krifka (eds.), *Biased questions: Experimental results & theoretical modelling*, 207–240. Berlin: Language Science Press.
- 2021 Troberg, Michelle & **Justin Leung**. On the unified change of directional/aspectual verb particles in French. *Journal of Historical Syntax* 5(40): 1–76.

Refereed (forthcoming)

- In press Ueda, Paul, Ka Fai Law, **Justin R. Leung** & Marjorie K.M. Chan. Generative artificial intelligence and sociolinguistic variation in Cantonese. In Cindy Wan Yee Lau, Siu-kei Cheng, Yik-Po Lai (eds.), *When Cantonese meets digital humanities*. Hong Kong: Hong Kong Polytechnic University Press.

Conference proceedings (abstract refereed)

- 2024 **Leung, Justin R.** I'm like, "like is not a complementizer, it seems like". In Gavin Bembridge (ed.), *Proceedings of the 2024 annual conference of the Canadian Linguistic Association*, 17.
- 2024 Kiss, Angelika, Jianing Zhou & **Justin R. Leung**. Declarative questions in Shanghainese and Cantonese. In Gavin Bembridge (ed.), *Proceedings of the 2024 annual conference of the Canadian Linguistic Association*, 14.
- 2022 **Leung, Justin R.** Given the sack, yet promoted: Passivizable V-IO-DO constructions in Cantonese. In Parisa Tarahomi (ed.), *Proceedings of the 2022 annual conference of the Canadian Linguistic Association*, 11.

- 2022 **Leung, Justin**. Variation in path encoding in motion events in Toronto Heritage Cantonese. *University of Pennsylvania Working Papers in Linguistics* 28(2): 10.

Non-refereed

- 2024 **Leung, Justin R.** & Dave Kush. Variation in Cantonese acceptability judgements due to language contact: An investigation of word order preferences in the resultative construction. *Buckeye East Asian Linguistics* 9: 94–113.

Submitted

Kiss, Angelika, **Justin R. Leung** & Jianing Zhou. Interrogative and declarative questions in Chinese.

Presentations

Abstract refereed

- 2025 **Leung, Justin R.** 2025. A multidimensional approach to heritage languages: Cantonese classifier constructions in Toronto [project launch]. Poster presented at the 53rd meeting of New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV 53), University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, November 5–7.
- 2024 **Leung, Justin R.** Agentive directional verbs in Cantonese are manner verbs. Paper presented at the Seventh Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL-7), Hong Kong Shue Yan University, Hong Kong/hybrid, June 22.
- 2024 **Leung, Justin R.** I'm like, "*like* is not a complementizer, it seems like". Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) Annual Conference, Carleton University, Ottawa, June 17–19.
- 2024 Kiss, Angelika, Jianing Zhou & **Justin Leung**. Declarative questions in Shanghaiese and Cantonese. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) Annual Conference, Carleton University, Ottawa, June 17–19.
- 2023 **Leung, Justin R.** Variation in Cantonese acceptability judgements due to language contact: An investigation of word order preferences in the resultative construction. Paper presented at the 27th International Conference on Yue Dialects (Yue 27), The Ohio State University, virtual, November 30–December 2.
- 2023 **Leung, Justin**. Setting straight the record straight: Acceptability of alternative word orders in resultatives by heritage Cantonese speakers. Paper presented at the 51st meeting of New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV 51), Queens College, New York City, October 13–15.
- 2023 **Leung, Justin R.** Deictic path elements in Cantonese directional motion constructions. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) Annual Conference, York University, Toronto, May 31–June 2.
- 2022 Diep, Brian, **Justin Leung** & Naomi Nagy. 邊啲人 [na:n²³] 啲? (n-/l-) in Cantonese in Hong Kong and Toronto. Paper presented at the Fifth Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL-5), City University of Hong Kong, virtual, June 4.
- 2022 **Leung, Justin**. Given the sack, yet promoted: Passivizable V-IO-DO constructions in Cantonese. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) Annual Conference, virtual, June 1–4.
- 2021 **Leung, Justin**. Variation in path encoding in motion events in Toronto Heritage Cantonese. Paper presented at the 49th meeting of New Ways of Analyzing Variation (NWAV 49), University of Texas at Austin, virtual, October 19–24.
- 2021 **Leung, Justin**. Variation in directional motion event expression in Toronto Heritage Cantonese. Paper presented at the 33rd North American Conference on Chinese Linguistics (NACCL 33), University of Chicago, virtual, June 24–25.

- 2021 **Leung, Justin**. Variation in directional motion event expression in Toronto Heritage Cantonese. Paper presented at the Fourth Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL-4), Hong Kong Baptist University, virtual, May 29.
- 2021 Lo, Roger Yu-Hsiang, **Justin Leung** & Angelika Kiss. Perceiving rhetorical questions in Cantonese. Paper presented at the Fourth Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL-4), Hong Kong Baptist University, virtual, May 29.
- 2021 Lo, Roger, Angelika Kiss & **Justin Leung**. Two types of rhetorical questions: Evidence from Cantonese prosody. Poster presented at the 95th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America (LSA), virtual, January 7–10.
- 2020 Troberg, Michelle & **Justin Leung**. On the uniform loss of Medieval French verb particles. Paper presented at the Canadian Linguistics Association (CLA) Annual Conference, virtual, May 30–June 1.

Non-refereed

- 2026 Kiss, Angelika, **Justin R. Leung** & Jianing Zhou. Interrogative and declarative sentences used as questions in Chinese. Poster presented at the third Polar Questions Across Languages meeting (POQAL-3), April 29–30.
- 2025 **Justin R. Leung**, Paul Ueda, Ka Fai Law & Marjorie K.M. Chan. The role of prompt language in Generative AI perception of regional variation. Paper presented at the 51st Annual Conference of the Linguistic Association of Canada and the United States (LACUS 51), Western University, London, Ontario, July 16–18.
- 2025 Ueda, Paul, Ka Fai Law, **Justin R. Leung** & Marjorie K.M. Chan. 2025. Harnessing generative artificial intelligence to study Cantonese linguistic variation. Paper presented at the 7th Workshop on Innovations in Cantonese Linguistics (WICL-7), Brigham Young University, Provo, Utah, April 11–12.
- 2025 Johnston, William & **Justin Leung**. 2025. A (de)prepositional approach to directed motion predicates in Cantonese and Hmong. Paper presented at the Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics 14 (TEAL-14), University of Southern California, Los Angeles, March 18–20.
- 2024 Ueda, Paul, Ka Fai Law, **Justin R. Leung** & Marjorie K.M. Chan. Generative artificial intelligence and regionally marked variation perception. Paper presented at the Conference on Language, Norms and Digital Lives, University of Copenhagen, Copenhagen/virtual, November 28–29.
- 2024 Kiss, Angelika, Jianing Zhou & **Justin Leung**. Declarative questions in Shanghainese and Cantonese. Paper presented at the 16th Toronto-Ottawa-Montreal Semantics Workshop (TOM 16), University of Toronto, Toronto, May 11.
- 2023 Diep, Brian, Douglas Quan, **Justin Leung** & Naomi Nagy. Variation in transcribing Heritage Cantonese. Paper presented at the 23rd Workshop on Cantonese (WOC-23), Hong Kong Baptist University, Hong Kong, June 24.
- 2022 **Leung, Justin R.** Determining the syntactic categories of directional elements in Cantonese. Paper presented at the 22nd Workshop on Cantonese (WOC-22), Chinese University of Hong Kong, virtual, June 25.
- 2022 **Leung, Justin**, Brian Diep & Naomi Nagy. ‘Lazy pronunciation’ in Toronto Heritage Cantonese: The case of (n-/l-). Paper presented at the 6th Workshop on Innovations in Cantonese Linguistics (WICL-6), The Ohio State University, virtual, May 27–28.
- 2022 **Leung, Justin**. Ordering multiple adnominal adjectives in Lingala. Paper presented at the Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Conference (MOTH), Université du Québec à Montréal, Montréal, April 22–23.

- 2021 **Leung, Justin**. Ordering multiple adnominal adjectives in Lingala. Paper presented at the 13th Annual Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Welcome Workshop, University of Toronto, virtual, November 5.
- 2021 **Leung, Justin**. The structure of directional motion events in Cantonese. Paper presented at the 8th Montreal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Conference (MOTH 8), McMaster University, virtual, April 19–20.
- 2021 Kiss, Angelika, Roger Yu-Hsiang Lo, **Justin Richard Leung** & Maxime Alexandra Tulling. What do Cantonese sentence-final particles tell us about rhetorical questions? Paper presented at the workshop on Biased Questions: Experimental Results & Theoretical Modelling, Leibniz-Zentrum Allgemeine Sprachwissenschaft, virtual, February 4–5.
- 2020 **Leung, Justin**. A quantitative approach to the loss of Medieval French verb particles. Paper presented at the 12th Annual Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Welcome Workshop, University of Toronto, virtual, October 16.
- 2020 **Leung, Justin**. The unified loss of verb particles in Medieval French: a quantitative analysis. Paper presented at the 13th Toronto Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (TULCON13), University of Toronto, Toronto, March 7–8.
- 2020 **Leung, Justin**. The unified loss of verb particles in Medieval French: a quantitative analysis. Paper presented at the 7th Scarborough Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (SULC), University of Toronto Scarborough, Toronto, February 28.

Invited lectures and talks

- 2024 **Leung, Justin R**. Word order in resultative constructions: The case of Heritage Cantonese. Lecture presented in LIN375 Chinese Linguistics (Dr. Lingzi Zhuang), University of Toronto Mississauga, Mississauga, December 2.
- 2024 **Leung, Justin R**. Directed motion constructions in Cantonese. Talk presented in the Research Opportunity Program (Dr. Michelle Troberg), University of Toronto Mississauga, Mississauga, November 29.
- 2023 **Leung, Justin R**. My path to research on Toronto Heritage Cantonese. Lecture presented in LIN199 Exploring Heritage Languages (Dr. Naomi Nagy), University of Toronto, Toronto, March 7.

Research Experience

Research assistantships

- 2020– **Heritage Language Variation and Change in Toronto (HLVC)**, *Linguistics, University of Toronto*
 PI: Dr. Naomi Nagy
 - Transcribed sociolinguistic interviews in ELAN
 - Conducted a sociolinguistic interview in Cantonese
 - Prepared and delivered presentations on findings and methods from lab projects
 - Coordinated tasks for undergraduate research assistants
- 2021– **Tritransitive Constructions**, *Linguistics, University of Toronto*
 PI: Dr. M. Cristina Cuervo
 - Read and synthesized background literature
 - Collected data for Cantonese and Mandarin
 - Provided support on using ELAN for the organization of elicitation sessions
 - Typeset a journal article using $\text{\LaTeX}$
- 2025– **Threshold Concepts in Syntax**, *Language Studies, University of Toronto Mississauga*
 PI: Dr. Michelle Troberg
 - Read background literature on threshold concepts
 - Analyzed student performance in undergraduate syntax courses
 - Prepared survey instruments to establish expert consensus on threshold concepts in syntax

2019–21, **Resultative Secondary Predication in Medieval French**, *Language Studies*, University of Toronto Mississauga

PI: Dr. Michelle Troberg

- Performed statistical analysis on French verb particles and resultatives
- Worked with the PI on writing and publishing a journal article, including L^AT_EX typesetting

Expert consultation

2023 **Language, Identity, Multiculturalism, and Global Empowerment (L'IMAGE) Project**, University of Toronto Mississauga

PI: Dr. Ai Taniguchi

- Reviewed and provided feedback on in the 2022–2023 L'IMAGE comics ([link](#))

Teaching Experience

Course instructorships

Linguistics, University of Toronto

LIN200 Introduction to Language
Summer 2025

Teaching assistantships and graderships

Language Studies, University of Toronto Mississauga

LIN102 Introduction to General Linguistics: Words, Sentences, Their Structure and Meaning
Winter 2024 (Head TA; Dr. Emily Atkinson)
Winter 2025 (Head TA; Dr. Michelle Troberg)
Winter 2026 (TA; Dr. Michelle Troberg)

Linguistics, University of Toronto

LIN101 Introduction to Linguistics: Sound Structure
Fall 2021 (TA; Dr. Nathan Sanders)

LIN102 Introduction to Linguistics: Sentence Structure and Meaning
Winter 2022 (TA; Dr. Keir Moulton, Dr. Susana Béjar)
Winter 2023 (TA; Dr. Neda Todorović, Liam Donohue)

LIN201 Canadian English
Winter 2023 (Grader; Dr. Marisa Brook)

LIN203 English Words
Fall 2020 (TA; Dr. Marisa Brook)

LIN204 English Grammar
Winter 2021 (TA; Heather Yawney, Emilia Melara)

LIN207 Language and Technology
Fall 2025 (TA; Dr. Guillaume Thomas)

LIN232 Syntactic Patterns in Language
Fall 2022 (TA; Dr. Ivan Bondoc)

LIN251 Introduction to Sociolinguistics
Fall 2022 (Grading support; Dr. Naomi Nagy)
Fall 2023, Fall 2024 (TA; Dr. Pocholo Umbal)

- ELL** English Language Learning reading support
2023–25 (Daveeda Goldberg, Dr. Nathan Sanders [2023–24], Dr. Suzi Lima [2024–25])
Courses served:
LIN251 Introduction to Sociolinguistics (Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Dr. Pocholo Umbal)
JLP315 Language Acquisition (Winter 2024, Winter 2025, Dr. Myrto Grigoroglou)
LIN402 Linguistic Typology and Constructed Languages (Winter 2024, Dr. Nathan Sanders)
JAL401/1145 Field Linguistics/Field Methods (Winter 2025, Dr. Suzi Lima)

Study group facilitation

University of Toronto Mississauga

- LIN101** Introduction to General Linguistics: The Sounds of Language
Winter 2019 (Dr. Jessamyn Schertz)
LIN102 Introduction to General Linguistics: Words, Sentences, Their Structure and Meaning
Fall 2018 (Dr. Arsalan Kahnemuyipour)
BIO207 Introductory Genetics
Winter 2018 (Dr. Jade Atallah)

Honours and Awards

Scholarships and fellowships

- 2025–26 **Doctoral Completion Award**, *University of Toronto*, \$6600
2022–26 **SSHRC Doctoral Fellowship**, *University of Toronto*, \$113 333
Complex event expression in two heritage varieties of Chinese in Toronto
2020 **Canada Graduate Scholarship—Master’s (SSHRC)**, *University of Toronto*, \$17 500
The expression of motion events in Cantonese and Hokkien heritage speakers in Canada
2015 **University of Toronto Mississauga Entrance Scholarship**, *University of Toronto Mississauga*, \$3000
2015 **University of Toronto Scholar**, *University of Toronto Mississauga*, \$6000

Awards

- 2023 **Elizabeth Cowper Prize**, *University of Toronto*, \$800
Syntax course paper “Like ‘complementizers’: are they like elements?”
2020 **Scarborough Undergraduate Linguistics Conference, 3rd place**, *University of Toronto Scarborough*, \$100
The unified loss of verb particles in Medieval French: a quantitative analysis
2018 **Trenwith Computer Science Award**, *University of Toronto Mississauga*, \$1107.36
2016 **Lawrence V. Redman Prize in Chemistry (Erindale)**, *University of Toronto Mississauga*, \$100

Research grants

- 2025 **Graduate Research Award**, *University of Toronto*, \$198.42
Funding for travel to NWAV 53
2025 **Graduate Research Award**, *University of Toronto*, \$606.47
Funding for dissertation research
2025 **Graduate Research Award**, *University of Toronto*, \$423.35
Funding for travel to TEAL-14
2023 **SSHRC Institutional Grant**, *University of Toronto*, \$500
Funding for travel to NWAV 51
2023 **SSHRC Institutional Grant**, *University of Toronto*, \$400
Funding for GP research

2023 **SSHRC Institutional Grant**, *University of Toronto*, \$350
Funding for travel to MOTH 2022

Service

Journal review

- 2022– Canadian Journal of Undergraduate Research (CJUR)
- 2021– Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics (TWPL)
- 2024 Buckeye East Asian Linguistics (BEAL)

Conference review

- 2026 Toronto Undergraduate Linguistics Conference (TULCON)
- 2025 Montréal-Ottawa-Toronto-Hamilton Syntax Workshop (MOTH)
- 2023, 2025 New Ways of Analyzing Variation (N WAV)
- 2023, 2024 Forum on Cantonese Linguistics (FoCaL)

Editorial work

- 2025– **Managing editor**, *Toronto Working Papers in Linguistics (TWPL)*
- 2024– **Proofreader**, *Language Science Press*
Volumes:
Formal approaches to complexity in heritage language grammars (edited by Maria Polinsky & Michael T. Putnam, 2024)
Linguistic dynamics in heritage speakers: Insights from the RUEG group (edited by Shanley E. M. Allen, Mareike Keller, Artemis Alexiadou, Heike Wiese, 2025)
Language landscapes: The ESL teacher's guide to how English works (Brett Reynolds, forthcoming)
- 2023 **Editor**
Heritage Languages: Extending Variationist Approaches (Naomi Nagy)

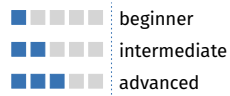
Other academic activities

- 2026 **Committee member**, *Linguistics Graduate Chair Advisory Committee, University of Toronto*
- 2024–25 **Student representative**, *Curriculum Committee, Linguistics, University of Toronto*
- 2024 **Student representative**, *Graduate Research Awards Committee, Linguistics, University of Toronto*
- 2023–24 **Committee member**, *Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Department Space Committee, University of Toronto*
- 2023 **Committee member**, *MoMOT 7 Organizing Committee*
- 2022–24 **Co-coordinator**, *Language Variation and Change (LVC) Research Group, Linguistics, University of Toronto*
- 2022–24 **Committee member**, *Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Grant Repository Committee, University of Toronto*
- 2020–24 **Committee member**, *Linguistics Graduate Course Union (LGCU) Website Committee, University of Toronto*

Other service

- 2017– **Administrator**, *English Wiktionary*
- 2014– **Autopatrolled contributor**, *English Wiktionary*

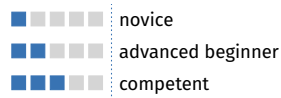
Languages



English	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Canadian
Yue	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Cantonese (heritage)
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Hoisanese (heritage)
Mandarin	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
French	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Southern Min	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Taiwanese/Hokkien
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Teochew
Hakka	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Siyen

Portuguese	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Haitian Creole	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Vietnamese	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Spanish	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	
Lingala	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	(fieldwork)

Skills



Office	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Microsoft Word
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Microsoft PowerPoint
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Microsoft Excel
Linguistics	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	ELAN
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Praat
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Gorilla
Programming	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	R
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Python
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Lua
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Java
Markup	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	LaTeX
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Wikitext
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Markdown

Website	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Squarespace
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Github Pages
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	HTML
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	CSS
Media	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Canva
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Photoshop
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	GIMP
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Inkscape
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Affinity
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	iMovie
	■ ■ ■ ■ ■	Audacity